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阅读 C

比较不一定是“快乐的窃贼”

议论文 · 心理与家庭 · 全文 387 词 · 逐句精读

¹ Not too long ago, on a cold winter night, there was a **teenager** who wanted more **screen time** and a **parent** who said no.

不久前的一个寒冷冬夜，一个青少年想多看一会儿屏幕，家长不同意。

teenager n. 青少年

screen time 看屏幕的时间

parent n. 父亲或母亲

² The teenager was **advocating for** her **right** to **scroll** (刷屏)
for an **extra** 30 minutes.

这个青少年正极力争取再多刷屏30分钟的权利。

advocate for 为……争取；为……据理力争

right n. 权利

scroll v. 刷屏；滚动浏览

extra adj. 额外的

³ The parent **argued** that **none of** her friends' parents let them have screens after 9 o'clock.

家长争辩说，她朋友的父母都不允许孩子晚上9点以后看屏幕。

argue v. 争辩

none of 没有一个

⁴ “I thought, in this family, we don’t **compare** ourselves **with** other people, Dad?” the teenager **replied**.

“爸爸，我以为在我们家，我们不和别人比较呢？”这个青少年回答说。

compare...with 把……与……比较

reply v. 回答

⁵ The parent — who was me, by the way — just got served.

那位家长——顺便说一句，就是我——被将了一军。

by the way 顺便说一句

get served 被驳倒；被将一军

⁶ Since they were young, I have told my kids not to compare themselves with other people.

从孩子们很小的时候起，我就一直告诉他们不要和别人比较。

compare oneself with 把自己与……比较

⁷ I have argued **countless** times that **comparisons** are the “**thief** of **joy**”.

我无数次地说过，比较是“快乐的窃贼”。

countless adj. 无数的

comparison n. 比较

thief n. 小偷；窃贼

joy n. 快乐

⁸ Although my daughter didn't win, she did help expose one of the worst pieces of advice I have ever given.

虽然我女儿没有赢，但她确实帮助揭露了我给过的最糟糕的建议之一。

expose v. 揭露

advice n. 建议

⁹ In my defence, I did what we've all done before, which is repeat received wisdom without exploring the nuances.

为我自己辩解一句，我做了我们大家以前都做过的事，那就是重复人们普遍接受的观点，而没有去探究其中的细微差别。

in one's defence 为某人辩护；为自己说句公道话

repeat v. 重复

received wisdom 公认的看法

explore v. 探究

nuance n. 细微差别

¹⁰ But now is the time to **set the record straight**, which starts with **questioning** the idea that all **social** comparison is **unhealthy**.

但现在是时候澄清事实了，首先就要质疑“所有社会比较都是不健康的”这一观点。

set the record straight 澄清事实

question v. 质疑

social adj. 社会的

unhealthy adj. 不健康的

¹¹ Social comparisons do, of course, often get us into emotional trouble.

当然，社会比较确实常常让我们陷入情绪困扰。

of course 当然

get...into trouble 使……陷入麻烦（困境）

¹² But they can be harnessed (利用) for our betterment if we understand how they work.

但如果我们了解它们的运作方式，就可以利用它们来让自己变得更好。

harness v. 利用

betterment n. 改善；进步

13 The social comparisons we make — ones that **lead us to** feel good or bad about ourselves — are **vital** to our **ability** to **thrive** (成长).

我们所做的社会比较——那些让我们自我感觉良好或糟糕的比较——对我们成长发展的能力至关重要。

lead sb to do sth 使某人做某事

vital adj. 至关重要的

ability n. 能力

thrive v. 茁壮成长

¹⁴ Science provides a guide we can use to harness the way we perform these comparisons to reduce their negative emotional impacts.

科学提供了一份指南，我们可以用它来驾驭自己进行比较的方式，从而减少比较带来的负面情绪影响。

provide v. 提供

guide n. 指南

perform v. 进行

reduce v. 减少

negative adj. 负面的

impact n. 影响

- 15 Comparing yourself with someone who is **outperforming** you could **result in** feelings of **envy** if you **focus on** the things they have and you don't, or it can be **energizing** and **inspiring** if you use these comparisons as a **source** of **motivation**, for example, “If they can **achieve** that, so can I.”

和比你表现更好的人比较，如果你盯着他们有而你没有的东西，就可能产生嫉妒；但如果你把这种比较当作动力来源，比如“他们能做到，我也能”，它就能让你充满干劲、受到鼓舞。

outperform v. 胜过

result in 导致

envy n. 嫉妒

focus on 关注

energizing adj. 使人充满活力的

inspiring adj. 鼓舞人心的

source n. 来源

motivation n. 动力

achieve v. 实现

- 16 Comparing yourself with someone who is doing worse than you could result in fear and worry if you think about how you could **fall into** **similar circumstances**, or it can **draw out** feelings of **gratitude** and **appreciation** if you use that comparison to **broaden** your **views** — for example, “Wow, things could be much worse; I’m doing great.”

和比你境况更差的人比较，如果你去想自己会不会也落入类似的处境，就可能产生恐惧和担忧；但如果你借这种比较开阔视野，比如“哇，情况本可能糟得多，我已经过得很好了”，它就能唤起感激和感恩之情。

fall into 陷入

similar adj. 类似的

circumstance n. 处境

draw out 引出

gratitude n. 感激

appreciation n. 感恩；感激

broaden v. 拓宽

view n. 视野；观点

¹⁷ What I **wish** I had taught my daughter **earlier** are these nuances.

我真希望当初早点教给女儿的，正是这些细微差别。

wish v. 真希望；要是……就好了（后接虚拟语气）

earlier adv. 早些

¹⁸ How we feel about ourselves rests not just on whom we compare ourselves with but also on how we think about that comparison.

我们对自己的感受，不仅取决于我们和谁比较，还取决于我们如何看待这种比较。

rest on 取决于

not just...but also 不仅……而且

19 That's something we all have control over.

这是我们每个人都能掌控的。

have control over 掌控